Safety and Retraction: eps2-proposed thesis (tested in ARA); bridge principle argued, not mechanically derived

Abstract

Disclosure: eps2-proposed thesis (tested in ARA); bridge principle argued, not mechanically derived. This paper proposes that, for the same earlier might-assertion and fixed context of use, an obligation on its speaker to retract at a later assessment context occurs if and only if the original belief fails worldly-information safety as evaluated at that later context. This paper argues that the sufficiency direction treats safety failure as enough for the obligation, while the necessity direction requires the separate assumption that no obligation arises when safety is preserved. This paper argues that the target is the obligation to retract that same assertion, not whether the speaker actually retracts, whether retraction is permissible, or whether another person rejects the assertion.

The exact disclosure is: eps2-proposed thesis (tested in ARA); bridge principle argued, not mechanically derived. This paper proposes that later, assessment-relative failure of the original belief's worldly-information safety counts as a defect warranting the original speaker's disavowal of that assertion through retraction. This paper argues that this bridge is not supplied by the cited literature and that the proposed biconditional depends on a further exhaustiveness assumption for its converse. This paper argues that each direction requires separate support: a sufficient trigger for an obligation does not by itself establish that the trigger is necessary.

Beddor and Goldstein formulate information-sensitive safety as a condition on knowledge (Beddor & Goldstein 2021, PDF pp. 5–15). MacFarlane states a sufficient condition for required retraction based on whether an assertion is true as used at its original context and assessed later (MacFarlane 2014, PDF pp. 122–123). Hawke examines a safety variant that drops a truth condition and presents countermodels to specified knowledge inferences (Hawke 2024, PDF pp. 29–30). Rudin reports a divergence between judgments that a might-claim is false and willingness to reject it (Rudin 2024, PDF pp. 7–9). This paper argues that these discussions do not establish the proposed safety-to-obligation bridge or its converse. This paper argues that safety failure must not be treated as equivalent to falsity, that rejection must not be treated as retraction, and that the sufficiency of a stated retraction norm must not be reversed to infer necessity. This paper argues that the iff is defended only conditionally: if the proposed bridge and the separate exhaustiveness assumption are accepted, the target follows for the fixed assertion and use context under consideration.

Methodology

Disclosure: eps2-proposed thesis (tested in ARA); bridge principle argued, not mechanically derived. The exact disclosure is: eps2-proposed thesis (tested in ARA); bridge principle argued, not mechanically derived. This paper argues that the test keeps the original might-assertion and its context

of use fixed while varying the later context of assessment. This paper argues that its outcome is specifically an obligation on the original speaker to retract that same assertion, not whether the speaker actually retracts it or another person rejects it.

This paper proposes that, for this fixed assertion and use context, an obligation to retract at a later assessment occurs if and only if the original belief fails worldly-information safety as evaluated there. This paper argues that the two directions require distinct tests: failure of safety must suffice for the obligation, and safety failure must also be necessary for it. This paper argues that the latter direction requires an exhaustiveness assumption: within the proposed norm, no independent ground imposes the relevant obligation while safety is preserved. This paper argues that neither direction follows merely from describing safety as relevant to knowledge.

Beddor and Goldstein formulate information-sensitive safety as a condition on knowledge (Beddor & Goldstein 2021, PDF pp. 5–15). They describe worldly information as relevant to knowing epistemic-modal propositions (Beddor & Goldstein 2021, PDF pp. 4–15). MacFarlane states a sufficient condition for required retraction based on whether an assertion is untrue as used at its original context and assessed later (MacFarlane 2014, PDF pp. 122–123). MacFarlane says he does not adopt the rejection approach, because retraction is clearer, and regards the retraction norm as sufficient to distinguish relativism from contextualism (MacFarlane 2014, PDF p. 125) (MacFarlane 2014, PDF pp. 122–123). Hawke examines a safety variant that drops a truth condition and presents countermodels to specified knowledge inferences (Hawke 2024, PDF pp. 29–30). Rudin reports a divergence between judgments that a might-claim is false and willingness to reject it (Rudin 2024, PDF pp. 7–9).

This paper argues that these source discussions concern distinct matters: a knowledge condition, truth at assessment, rejection, and an obligation to retract. This paper argues that the proposed bridge from assessment-relative safety failure to a retraction obligation is not established by transferring a knowledge condition to the normative status of an assertion. This paper argues that Hawke's knowledge-inference results do not establish a retraction norm, and that MacFarlane's truth-based sufficient condition is not the proposed safety-based biconditional. This paper argues that rejection by another speaker, as discussed by Rudin, is not by itself evidence of the original speaker's retrospective obligation. This paper argues that knowledge loss, falsity, belief loss, actual retraction, and rejection must therefore not be treated as interchangeable with that obligation without a separate argument.

This paper argues that the dossier's verdict applies only to the stated 2018–2026-10-29 bounded search and inspected texts: support for the exact claim was not located there. This paper argues that this verdict does not certify novelty, truth, or an open problem. This paper argues that the proposed biconditional is defended only conditionally, if both the safety-to-obligation bridge and the separate exhaustiveness assumption are accepted. This paper argues that fixing the earlier might-assertion and its context of use isolates the question of whether its original speaker is obligated to retract that assertion at a later assessment.

Safety, worldly information, and the retraction norm

Beddor and Goldstein formulate information-sensitive safety as a condition on knowledge: a belief amounts to knowledge only if it satisfies the specified safety condition across nearby worlds where the belief is held (Beddor & Goldstein 2021, PDF pp. 5–15). They describe worldly information as a body of information determined by each possible world and relevant to knowing epistemic-modal claims (Beddor & Goldstein 2021, PDF pp. 4–15). These are claims about knowledge and the information relevant to it.

MacFarlane states a sufficient condition for required retraction: an assertion is required to be retracted when it is not true as used at its original context and assessed later (MacFarlane 2014, PDF pp. 122–123). He distinguishes this retraction obligation from the rule governing whether an assertion may be made (MacFarlane 2014, PDF pp. 122–123). MacFarlane says he does not adopt the rejection approach, because retraction is clearer, and regards the retraction norm as sufficient to distinguish relativism from contextualism (MacFarlane 2014, PDF p. 125) (MacFarlane 2014, PDF pp. 122–123).

This paper proposes that, for the same earlier might-assertion and fixed use context, obligatory retraction at a later assessment occurs if and only if the original belief fails worldly-information safety as evaluated there. This paper argues that the target is the original speaker's obligation to retract that same assertion; it is not actual retraction, permissibility, or another speaker's rejection. This paper argues that, under the proposal's separate exhaustiveness assumption, safety preservation rules out an obligation to retract.

This paper argues that these source discussions distinguish the safety condition, truth at assessment, and the normative status of retraction, but do not establish the proposed biconditional. This paper argues that a condition on knowledge cannot be transferred to an obligation governing an assertion without a further principle connecting them. This paper argues that MacFarlane's truth-based sufficient trigger does not establish a safety-based trigger, much less its converse. This paper argues that the knowledge condition and the retraction norm must therefore remain distinct in assessing the proposal.

This paper argues that the bridge from safety failure to retraction obligation is proposed, not mechanically derived from these sources. This paper argues that the biconditional holds conditionally: if the bridge and the separate exhaustiveness assumption are accepted, the proposal applies to the fixed assertion and use context at the later assessment.

The proposed bridge and the sufficient direction

This paper proposes that, for a fixed earlier might-assertion and context of use, later-assessed failure of the original belief's worldly-information safety counts as a defect warranting an obligation on the original speaker to retract that same assertion. This paper argues that the sufficiency direction is a proposed normative bridge: the later safety failure must count, within the proposed norm, as a defect

warranting disavowal of the original assertoric commitment. This paper argues that the claimed outcome is an obligation to retract, not an actual retraction, permission to retract, or a different speaker's rejection of the claim.

This paper argues that the bridge's terms must remain distinct. This paper argues that safety failure is the specified condition evaluated at the later assessment; falsity at that assessment is not built into the proposed trigger. This paper argues that the proposal does not claim that a belief's failure of safety entails that the assertion was false. This paper argues that its claim is limited to the connection it proposes between the specified safety failure and the specified obligation, rather than a general principle about what follows from every loss of safety.

Hawke examines a safety variant that drops a truth condition and gives countermodels to specified knowledge inferences (Hawke 2024, PDF pp. 29–30). This paper argues that those results do not establish an obligation to retract. This paper argues that treating safety as if it already included a truth condition would not supply the proposed bridge; the two notions must remain distinct in assessing the claim.

MacFarlane states a rule requiring retraction when an assertion is not true as used at its original context and assessed from the later context (MacFarlane 2014, PDF pp. 122–123). This paper argues that this truth-based rule provides an attributed comparison, not the proposed inference from safety failure to retraction obligation. This paper argues that the comparison identifies the relevant two-context structure—original use and later assessment—while leaving the proposed safety-based trigger to be argued separately.

This paper reasons that the sufficiency direction is conditional on accepting the bridge principle: if later-assessed failure of the original belief's worldly-information safety counts as a defect warranting disavowal of that original commitment, then the proposal requires its speaker to retract the same assertion. This paper argues that the bridge is not mechanically derived from a condition on knowledge, because the proposed conclusion concerns an assertion obligation. This paper argues that the sufficiency claim does not settle whether the belief remains knowledge, whether it is false, or whether another person may reject it; those are distinct questions from the proposed retraction obligation. This paper argues that fixing the assertion, use context, later assessment, and relevant outcome prevents the sufficient direction from being mistaken for a claim about actual retraction or another speaker's response.

This paper argues that the proposed trigger must be read at the specified later assessment: the norm concerns whether the original belief fails worldly-information safety as evaluated there, not whether it failed safety at the time of assertion. This paper argues that holding the use context fixed keeps the target constant while assessment changes. This paper proposes that, for the same assertion and fixed use context, later-assessed safety failure warrants an obligation on the original speaker to retract that assertion. This paper argues that the proposal's trigger and outcome are thus linked by a normative rule, rather than by an identity between a belief condition and an assertion obligation.

Hawke examines a safety variant that removes a truth condition and gives countermodels to specified knowledge inferences (Hawke 2024, PDF pp. 29–30). This paper argues that this discussion keeps safety and truth distinct but does not itself state a retraction norm. This paper argues that the proposed bridge must therefore be assessed as its own normative commitment: accepting that the later safety failure warrants disavowal is what connects the specified condition to the obligation. This paper argues that the bridge does not require adding falsity as a second trigger. This paper argues that the sufficiency claim is only that, if the specified safety failure obtains and the bridge is accepted, the obligation follows; it does not claim that safety failure makes the earlier assertion false.

MacFarlane states a Retraction Rule requiring retraction when an assertion is not true as used at its original context and assessed later (MacFarlane 2014, PDF pp. 122–123). This paper argues that his rule provides a comparison for the structure of the case: an earlier assertion is assessed from a later context. This paper argues that its truth-based condition cannot simply be replaced by safety failure without the proposed bridge. This paper argues that the cited rule does not establish that safety failure is sufficient for an obligation, because the conditions named by the two rules differ. This paper argues that the analogy therefore clarifies the proposal's two-context structure, while leaving its safety-to-obligation connection as a premise to be defended.

This paper argues that the conclusion remains conditional on accepting that connection. This paper argues that no conclusion about the belief's knowledge status, the assertion's truth, or an actual retraction is needed for this sufficient direction. This paper argues only that, under the proposed norm and with the same assertion and use context fixed, later-assessed safety failure brings an obligation to retract that assertion.

Necessity, exhaustiveness, and objections

This paper proposes that, for the same earlier might-assertion and fixed use context, obligatory retraction at a later assessment context occurs if and only if the original belief fails worldly-information safety as evaluated there. This paper argues that the necessity direction is a separate commitment: when the belief remains safe under the specified assessment-relative criterion, the proposed norm imposes no obligation to retract. This paper argues that this direction does not follow merely from a claim that safety failure is sufficient for an obligation. This paper argues that a sufficient trigger need not be the only trigger: even if safety failure entails an obligation, an independent ground could also impose one while safety is preserved, leaving the converse unsettled.

This paper argues that the converse therefore depends on an exhaustiveness assumption. This paper proposes that the restricted norm is exhaustive: no independent ground imposes an obligation to retract the same assertion while the original belief remains safe by the specified criterion. This paper argues that the assumption is needed to support the claim that safety preservation rules out an obligation: without it, the possibility of an independent ground remains open. This paper argues that the assumption is not itself supplied by the safety condition, which concerns the original belief, or by the proposal's sufficiency direction, which connects safety failure to an obligation.

This paper objects that a speaker might have some other reason to retract while safety is preserved. This paper objects that the necessity claim, not the sufficiency claim, is challenged by a case in which an independent ground imposes the relevant obligation despite safety preservation. This paper argues that the objection shows why safety preservation alone does not establish the no-obligation result. This paper argues that if an independent ground can impose the obligation within the target scope, the biconditional is not established by the safety criterion alone.

MacFarlane states that there is nothing inherently wrong with retracting an assertion one still thinks true, including when one does not want others to rely on one's word or does not want to take on the obligation of defending the assertion (MacFarlane 2014, PDF pp. 122–123). This paper argues that this discussion makes it important to keep permissibility distinct from obligation. This paper argues that the fact that a speaker may retract an assertion despite still thinking it true does not, by itself, show that the speaker is required to retract it. This paper argues that the discussion therefore does not itself refute the narrower proposal about obligatory retraction; rather, it leaves the exhaustiveness assumption to be defended for that restricted norm.

This paper replies that the proposed target is not a claim about every permissible retraction or every possible reason to retract. This paper argues that the claim concerns whether, for the same earlier might-assertion and fixed use context, the original speaker has an obligation to retract at the later assessment. This paper argues that the converse is defensible only if the relevant norm is restricted so that safety failure exhausts the grounds for that obligation. This paper argues that if that assumption is accepted, safety preservation excludes an obligation under the proposed norm; absent the assumption, that conclusion remains unsupported.

Rudin reports a divergence between judgments that a might-claim is false and willingness to reject it (Rudin 2024, PDF pp. 7–9). This paper argues that an assessor's willingness to reject an assertion is not, by itself, evidence that its original speaker has a retrospective obligation to retract it. This paper argues that rejection and retraction obligation are distinct outcomes, and that the reported divergence does not establish either direction of the proposed safety-to-obligation biconditional. This paper argues that it cannot substitute for the exhaustiveness assumption: willingness to reject does not show that safety preservation creates, or fails to create, an obligation on the original speaker.

This paper argues that the two directions must therefore remain separately stated. This paper argues that the sufficiency direction requires accepting the proposed bridge from a later-assessed safety failure to an obligation on the original speaker to retract that same assertion. This paper argues that the necessity direction additionally requires the exhaustiveness assumption that no independent ground imposes that obligation when safety is preserved. This paper argues that neither the cited permission to retract nor reported willingness to reject supplies that assumption. This paper proposes the biconditional only conditionally, with the original assertion and use context fixed, and with the outcome limited to an obligation to retract.

Scope, comparison, and conclusion

Beddor and Goldstein formulate information-sensitive safety as a condition on knowledge (Beddor & Goldstein 2021, PDF pp. 5–15) and describe worldly information as relevant to knowing epistemic-modal claims (Beddor & Goldstein 2021, PDF pp. 4–15). Hawke tests a safety variant without a truth condition and supplies countermodels to specified knowledge inferences (Hawke 2024, PDF pp. 29–30). MacFarlane states a truth-at-assessment condition for required retraction and allows that one may retract an assertion one still thinks true (MacFarlane 2014, PDF pp. 122–123). MacFarlane says he does not adopt the rejection approach, because retraction is clearer, and regards the retraction norm as sufficient to distinguish relativism from contextualism (MacFarlane 2014, PDF p. 125) (MacFarlane 2014, PDF pp. 122–123). Rudin reports a divergence between judgments that a might-claim is false and willingness to reject it (Rudin 2024, PDF pp. 7–9).

This paper argues that these discussions address distinct matters—knowledge and safety, truth at assessment, retraction obligation, and rejection—and do not establish the proposed safety-to-obligation biconditional. This paper argues that neither a knowledge condition nor a truth-based retraction rule supplies the proposed safety-based bridge, and that permission to reject is not itself an obligation to retract. This paper argues that the cited distinction between rejection and retraction also prevents treating another speaker's rejection as the original speaker's retrospective obligation.

This paper argues that the dossier's verdict is limited to its stated 2018–2026-10-29 bounded search and inspected texts: it records that support for the exact claim was not located there, not that the claim is novel or true. This paper proposes that, for the same earlier might-assertion and fixed use context, obligatory retraction at a later assessment occurs if and only if the original belief fails worldly-information safety as evaluated there. This paper argues that, under the proposal's separate exhaustiveness assumption, safety preservation rules out an obligation to retract. This paper argues that the claim concerns an obligation on the original speaker to retract that same assertion—not actual retraction, permission to retract, or another speaker's rejection. This paper argues that the iff is defended conditionally: its sufficiency direction depends on the proposed bridge from later-assessed safety failure to obligation, while its necessity direction additionally depends on the separate exhaustiveness assumption that no independent ground imposes the obligation when safety is preserved. This paper argues that the comparison does not independently establish the conclusion; it stands or falls with those proposed commitments.

Status and method

This PDF presents the verified pre-polish essay, without Opus edits. Its original native audit returned [0, 0, 0] flags across three samples. Later polished revisions were not accepted. The origin label is retained. This note, citation display and page layout were added for delivery.

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